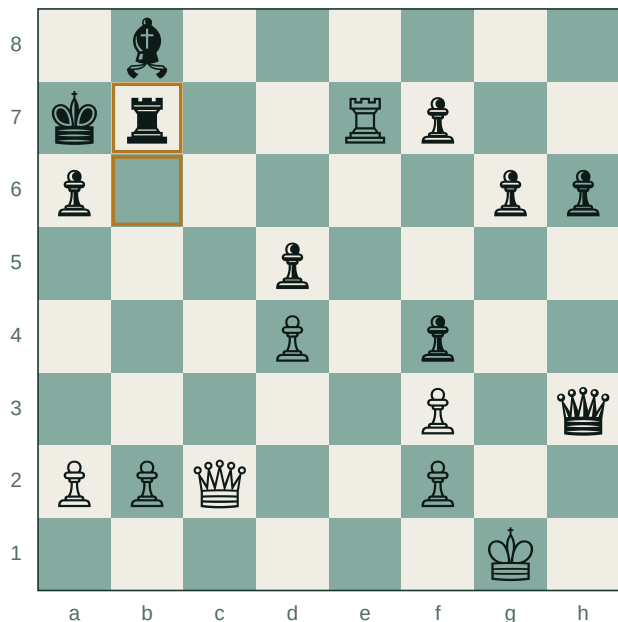


Pins and pressure: White, move 30

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 29...Rb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Qc5+ Ka8 31. Qc6 Qc8 32. Qxc8

30.Qc5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **30...Ka8**.

31.Qc6 The queen moves from c5 to c6. Recorded reply: **31...Qc8**.

32.Qxc8 The queen captures the queen on c8. From c8 it attacks rook on b7 and bishop on b8.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -4 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on a7. Absolute pin: rook on b7.